

careless spending instead of saving for boring retirement, the fact is if you think ahead now, it will reduce stress in the future.

How to Make Budgeting Easier: More Money

Achieving financial stability is hard. You might be reading this and thinking, “I can barely pay my rent. How in the world am I supposed to have an emergency fund, invest in my retirement, and save for a home?” I get it. But the obvious and irritating answer to this question is that your goals will become more attainable when you make more money. At some point, there is no amount of coupon-cutting or thrifty living that will help if you are not making enough money.

My best advice in this area is to adopt an entrepreneurial spirit. I have been an Uber driver, worked as a bartender on weekends, tutored students after school, organized and taught classes on personal finance, and written this book to try to boost my income. While it is a lot of work, and not always glamorous, I know the key to achieving my financial goals requires more money in my budget. Think about the skills you have that you could use to make extra money each month, even if it is only \$100.

If you don’t have a job, apply for everything you can. If you are already working, see how you can leverage your position into more money. If you have just started, work your tail off so your employer knows how valuable you are. Once you have proven your worth, you may be able to ask for a raise. If you have already been working for a while, see if you are being paid fairly. If you find out you are making less money than many others who are in your position, you can ask your boss for a raise or begin looking for a job at a new company that will pay you more. Remember,